

What is the central idea in Drama: character and stagecraft?

Drama meaning arises through spoken lines and performance possibilities: entrances, exits, silence, props, interruptions and audience knowledge.

9695-01-C1

QUESTION + ANSWER

What is the central idea in Poetry: voice, image and form?

Distinguish poet from speaker. Sound, imagery, line breaks, stanza patterns and shifts in tone make meaning together; naming a metaphor without explaining its effect earns little.

9695-02-C1

QUESTION + ANSWER

What is the central idea in Prose: narrative methods?

Narrative perspective controls what readers can know. Focalisation is whose perceptions shape a scene; an unreliable narrator may misread or withhold.

9695-03-C1

QUESTION + ANSWER

What is the central idea in Unseen close reading?

Read the whole unseen text first for situation, voice and any turn before annotating local details. Build an interpretation from patterns of diction, rhythm, perspective and structure.

9695-04-C1

QUESTION + ANSWER

Which mechanism, condition or distinction matters in Drama: character and stagecraft?

A close response links the precise wording of a line to dramatic position and plausible stage effect, while acknowledging that a script permits more than one performance.

9695-01-C2

QUESTION + ANSWER

Which mechanism, condition or distinction matters in Poetry: voice, image and form?

Analyse how an image develops across the poem and how form changes the reader's pace or expectation.

9695-02-C2

QUESTION + ANSWER

Which mechanism, condition or distinction matters in Prose: narrative methods?

Time shifts, dialogue and free indirect style affect sympathy. Link a short passage to wider patterns in the prescribed novel where the question requires whole-text knowledge.

9695-03-C2

QUESTION + ANSWER

Which mechanism, condition or distinction matters in Unseen close reading?

Refer to the beginning and ending; alternative readings must remain anchored in textual evidence, without biography or invented historical context.

9695-04-C2

QUESTION + ANSWER

Original micro-scene: MAYA: "The door was open." (She pockets the key.) ARUN: "Then why knock?" Discuss how dialogue and action create uncertainty.

A strong essay explores the key as possible concealment, the contradiction between "open" and knocking, and audience knowledge of the stage action. Alternative readings of Maya's motive are welcome when supported; do not assert a single definitive intention.

9695-01-P

QUESTION + ANSWER

Original lines: "The clock kept rain inside its face. / At noon the windows learned to blur." Explore two possible effects of the imagery and line break.

A strong answer connects clock/rain metaphor to time and weather, notes personification "windows learned," considers unstable perceptions, and discusses pacing created by the break. Ground interpretations in the exact original wording.

9695-02-P

QUESTION + ANSWER

Original extract: "Jonah said the house was empty. He avoided the upstairs light and left its switch untouched." Explain how viewpoint and detail shape trust in Jonah.

A strong response explores "said" as unverified report, avoidance and untouched switch as suggestive gaps, and resists claiming the light proves a ghost or crime. Structure paragraphs around reader knowledge and withheld information.

9695-03-P

QUESTION + ANSWER

Original extract: "Each morning she set two cups on the table. By winter the second cup held only the kitchen light." Comment on ways time and image convey change.

A strong answer connects "each morning" to ritual and "by winter" to elapsed time; the absent companion is suggested, not confirmed. The second cup becomes a vessel for light rather than tea, allowing grief, separation or change as supported interpretations.

9695-04-P

QUESTION + ANSWER

Which mechanism, condition or distinction matters in Comparative dramatic interpretation?

Compare effects through evidence and the question's exact terms. Evaluate readings by asking which scene details they clarify and which they overlook.

9695-06-C2

QUESTION + ANSWER

Which mechanism, condition or distinction matters in Poetry across periods?

A text's date matters when a specific convention or social relation helps interpret a wording; do not invent an author's intention.

9695-07-C2

QUESTION + ANSWER

Original lines A: "At six the bells divide the day." B: "No bell could hold the hours apart." Compare the speakers' attitudes to measured time.

A strong response contrasts division/order in A with defiance or flux in B, explains modal "could," and resists attributing centuries or named writers from these lines alone. For set texts add accurate context and close textual support.

9695-07-P

QUESTION + ANSWER

What is the central idea in Shakespeare: language and performance?

Interpret Shakespearean speech through situation, verse/prose, imagery, rhetorical pattern and relationships on stage.

9695-05-C1

QUESTION + ANSWER

Original invented line for practice: "My crown is lighter when the room is dark." Discuss possible meanings and ways an actor might voice it; then apply the method to a set Shakespeare passage.

A strong response explores crown as political burden, darkness as secrecy or rest, and actor choices of emphasis/pause. It is a technique exercise; the original line is not a quotation from Shakespeare or a prescribed play.

9695-05-P

QUESTION + ANSWER

What is the central idea in Poetry across periods?

Period labels can inform genre and context but should never replace close reading. Compare voice, form, images and attitudes on a shared issue, making space for differences within an era.

9695-07-C1

QUESTION + ANSWER

What is the central idea in Prose across periods?

A prose essay can combine detailed passage analysis with knowledge of the whole prescribed work.

9695-08-C1

QUESTION + ANSWER

Which mechanism, condition or distinction matters in Shakespeare: language and performance?

A soliloquy makes the audience privy to thought; an aside may separate speaker and characters. Quote accurately from the prescribed edition and discuss how different performances could alter tone.

9695-05-C2

QUESTION + ANSWER

What is the central idea in Comparative dramatic interpretation?

At A Level consider how dramatic form, contexts and different critical interpretations illuminate the chosen set texts without turning context into an unrelated history essay.

9695-06-C1

QUESTION + ANSWER

Original prompt: A character refuses to answer a public accusation but speaks freely alone afterward. Explore two interpretations of the silence and the dramatic contrast.

A strong answer weighs fear against deliberate resistance, analyses audience access to later private speech, and treats performance choices as plausible alternatives. Transfer the method to the set drama text with precise references.

9695-06-P

QUESTION + ANSWER

Which mechanism, condition or distinction matters in Prose across periods?

Track shifts in narrative stance, dialogue, description and temporal structure; historical context should sharpen a claim based on words. Critical interpretations can differ, but explain why one fits a passage better.

9695-08-C2

QUESTION + ANSWER

Original extract: "The garden seemed endless to its owner. For the gardener, the gate was the last place the day's wages reached." Explore how perspective shapes the idea of ownership.

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A strong essay contrasts owner/gardener focalisation, "endless" against the wage boundary and possible irony in "seemed." Move from local language to class relations cautiously; apply method to a chosen 2026 set prose text.